

Password and Authentication Policy

Purpose

The purpose of these guidelines is to provide recommendations for best practices for developing strong passwords and authentication methods.

Scope

These guidelines pertain to all employees in all departments at Botium Toys. These should be applied to all user accounts and all assets within the company that require passwords to set up and operate.

Safeguards

- Passwords are stronger the longer they are. Enforcement of the length of password is highly recommended (a minimum of 16 characters)
- Require multifactor authentication
 - A two-step process. Having a second point of lock to pass through before granting access and/or authentication.
- Periodically reauthenticate users, services, and hardware based on risk (e.g., in zero trust architectures).
- Enforce users to log back in periodically to ensure that the user is still who they say they are and the accounts have not been compromised.
- In a scenario where an admin user or manager is not present and unreachable, an emergency mechanism should be in place so critical systems aren't completely locked out to a user who needs access to respond to the situation.

Policy Sanctions

Non-compliance with this policy may result in disciplinary action in line with Botium Toys' human resources procedures. Consequences may range from mandatory refresher training and written warnings to temporary suspension of access privileges and, in severe cases, termination of employment or contractual obligations. Individuals could be subject to legal consequences under applicable laws if violations involve illegal activities. Enforcement will be consistent and impartial, with the severity of the action corresponding directly to the seriousness of the violation.